

SOCIAL SKILLS WORKBOOK

FOR KIDS AGES 6-12

Making Friends, Managing Emotions & Speaking Up

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WHAT ARE SOCIAL SKILLS?

Social skills are the tools we use to get along with others!

They help you:

- Make and keep friends
- Tell people how you feel
- Solve problems without fighting
- Feel confident in groups
- Stand up for yourself kindly

Everyone can learn social skills - even grown-ups are still learning!

In this workbook, you'll practice:

- Reading faces and body language
- Starting conversations
- Managing big feelings
- Being a great friend
- Handling tough situations

Ready? Let's go!

READING FACIAL EXPRESSIONS

Match the description to the emotion!

Eyebrows up, mouth open wide

_____ (Surprised!)

Eyebrows down, lips pressed tight

_____ (Angry)

Corners of mouth up, eyes crinkled

_____ (Happy)

Corners of mouth down, eyes droopy

_____ (Sad)

Eyes wide, body pulled back

_____ (Scared)

Nose wrinkled, tongue out

_____ (Disgusted)

One eyebrow up, head tilted

_____ (Confused)

Looking away, fidgeting

_____ (Nervous)

BODY LANGUAGE DECODER

What does their body say? Circle: FRIENDLY or NOT FRIENDLY

Arms crossed, looking away

Friendly / Not Friendly

Leaning in, smiling

Friendly / Not Friendly

Turned away, feet pointing to door

Friendly / Not Friendly

Eye contact, nodding

Friendly / Not Friendly

Yawning, checking phone

Friendly / Not Friendly

Waving, moving closer

Friendly / Not Friendly

MY body language when I'm happy:

MY body language when I'm upset:

PERSONAL SPACE AWARENESS

Everyone has a 'bubble' of personal space!

CLOSE (arm's length)

Who belongs here: Family, best friends, pets

MEDIUM (2 arm's lengths)

Who belongs here: Friends, classmates, teachers

FAR (3+ arm's lengths)

Who belongs here: Strangers, people you just met

Signs someone needs MORE space:

- They step back - They lean away - They look uncomfortable

What to do: Take a step back and ask 'Is this okay?'

STARTING CONVERSATIONS

3 Easy Ways to Start Talking:

COMPLIMENT + QUESTION

'I like your [backpack]. Where did you get it?'

SHARED EXPERIENCE

'That math test was hard! How did you feel about it?'

OFFER HELP

'Need a partner for the project? Want to work together?'

PRACTICE: Write your own conversation starters!

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

JOINING A GROUP

Step 1: WATCH - Observe what they're doing (don't just jump in)

Step 2: WAIT - Find the right moment (a pause or break)

Step 3: APPROACH - Move closer with friendly body language

Step 4: ASK - 'Can I play?' or 'Can I join you?'

Step 5: BLEND IN - Follow their rules, don't try to change the game

If they say no:

- It's okay! It's not about you.
- Find another group or start your own game.
- Ask a teacher for help if needed.

TAKING TURNS & SHARING

Why taking turns matters: Everyone gets a chance to be included!

Scenario: Your friend wants to play a different game than you.

Fair solution: _____

Scenario: You've been waiting a long time for the swing.

Fair solution: _____

Scenario: Someone took the last cookie.

Fair solution: _____

Scenario: Your sibling won't share the tablet.

Fair solution: _____

MANAGING BIG FEELINGS - CALM-DOWN TOOLKIT

1. BREATHE: Smell the flower (in), blow out the candle (out) x5
2. COUNT: Count backward from 10 slowly
3. SQUEEZE: Make fists tight for 5 seconds, then release
4. MOVE: Do 10 jumping jacks or run in place
5. DRAW: Scribble out your feelings on paper
6. TALK: Tell someone 'I feel ____ because ____'
7. SPACE: Go to your calm-down corner
8. THINK: Will this matter tomorrow? Next week?

My top 3 calm-down tools:

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

DEALING WITH DISAGREEMENTS

PROBLEM-SOLVING STEPS:

1. STOP - Don't react right away. Take a breath.
2. SAY what happened (facts only, no name-calling)
3. LISTEN to their side (really listen!)
4. BRAINSTORM solutions together (at least 3 ideas)
5. CHOOSE one you both agree on
6. TRY IT - if it doesn't work, try another solution

Practice: A disagreement I had:

What happened: _____

How I solved it (or could have): _____

STANDING UP FOR YOURSELF

Assertive = Standing up for yourself WITHOUT being mean

The Assertiveness Formula:

'I feel [emotion] when you [action]. Please [what you need].'

Examples:

'I feel upset when you take my things. Please ask first.'

'I feel left out when you whisper. Please include me.'

'I feel frustrated when you cut in line. Please wait your turn.'

YOUR TURN - Write your own:

'I feel _____ when you _____. Please _____.'

BEING A GOOD FRIEND CHECKLIST

- ☐ I listen when my friend talks
- ☐ I take turns and share
- ☐ I say nice things
- ☐ I include others
- ☐ I keep promises and secrets
- ☐ I apologize when I'm wrong
- ☐ I stand up for my friends
- ☐ I celebrate their successes
- ☐ I respect their boundaries
- ☐ I'm honest but kind
- ☐ I make time for them
- ☐ I forgive mistakes

HANDLING TEASING & BULLYING

Response Options (choose what works for the situation):

1. IGNORE - Walk away. Don't give a reaction.
2. AGREE - 'Yeah, maybe!' (takes away their power)
3. HUMOR - Make a joke and walk away
4. ASSERTIVE - 'Stop. I don't like that.'
5. TELL AN ADULT - Always okay, especially if unsafe
6. BUDDY SYSTEM - Stay with friends

IMPORTANT: Bullying is NOT your fault.

Adults I can tell: _____

ACTIVE LISTENING & COMPLIMENTS

ACTIVE LISTENING (HEAR):

H - Hold still (no fidgeting)

E - Eyes on the speaker

A - Ask questions to show interest

R - Repeat back what you heard

GIVING COMPLIMENTS:

Be specific! Not just 'nice job' but 'I loved how you...'

Practice - Give a compliment to:

A friend: _____

A family member: _____

Yourself: _____

RECEIVING COMPLIMENTS:

Just say 'Thank you!' (Don't argue or put yourself down)

SOCIAL SCENARIO #1

SITUATION:

A new kid joins your class and sits alone at lunch.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Invite them to sit with you / Ask what they like / Share something

SOCIAL SCENARIO #2

SITUATION:

Your friend is crying because they got a bad grade.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Listen / Don't say 'it's not a big deal' / Offer to help study

SOCIAL SCENARIO #3

SITUATION:

Someone cuts in front of you in line.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Say calmly 'I was here first' / Tell teacher if they won't move

SOCIAL SCENARIO #4

SITUATION:

You accidentally hurt someone's feelings.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Apologize sincerely / Ask how to make it better

SOCIAL SCENARIO #5

SITUATION:

A group is playing and you want to join.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Watch, wait, approach, ask, blend in

SOCIAL SCENARIO #6

SITUATION:

Your friend wants to copy your homework.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Say no kindly / Offer to help them understand instead

SOCIAL SCENARIO #7

SITUATION:

Someone is being mean to another kid.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Stand up for them / Get an adult / Don't join in

SOCIAL SCENARIO #8

SITUATION:

You disagree with your friend about what game to play.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Take turns / Compromise / Find something you both like

SOCIAL SCENARIO #9

SITUATION:

You feel left out because your friends made plans without you.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Tell them how you feel / It might not be on purpose

SOCIAL SCENARIO #10

SITUATION:

Someone spread a rumor about you.

WHAT COULD YOU DO? (write 3 options):

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

BEST CHOICE and WHY:

HELPFUL HINT:

Don't spread it back / Talk to an adult / Confront calmly

MY SOCIAL GOALS

Social skills I'm already good at:

- _____
- _____
- _____

Skills I want to work on:

- _____
- _____
- _____

My #1 goal this month:

How I'll practice:

WEEKLY FRIENDSHIP TRACKER - WEEK 1

Monday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Tuesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Wednesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Thursday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Friday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

This week I'm proud of: _____

WEEKLY FRIENDSHIP TRACKER - WEEK 2

Monday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Tuesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Wednesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Thursday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Friday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

This week I'm proud of: _____

WEEKLY FRIENDSHIP TRACKER - WEEK 3

Monday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Tuesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Wednesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Thursday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Friday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

This week I'm proud of: _____

WEEKLY FRIENDSHIP TRACKER - WEEK 4

Monday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Tuesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Wednesday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Thursday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

Friday

Kind thing I did: _____

Social skill I practiced: _____

Challenge I faced: _____

This week I'm proud of: _____

CERTIFICATE OF SOCIAL SKILLS MASTERY

This certifies that

(your name)

has completed this workbook and demonstrated

excellent social skills including:

Making Friends | Managing Emotions | Speaking Up

Listening | Kindness | Problem Solving

Date: ____/____/____

Congratulations! You are a Social Skills CHAMPION!